

Vinay Degavath

Director of Product | Fintech · Lending · AI

IIT Kharagpur | Token 2049 Speaker

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SUMMARY

Product leader, 13+ years fintech/DeFi/AI. Head of Product at Finin — neobank acquired by Open Financial Technologies (employee #2). Founded Hashstack, a DeFi lending protocol: \$1M seed + additional private funding, 36K on-chain users, 16 engineers. Designed an AI consumer product from domain expertise.

EXPERIENCE

Hashstack Finance

2020 – 2026

Founder & CEO — [hashstack.finance](#)

Bengaluru

- Raised \$1M seed + additional private funding; acquired 36,000 on-chain users at \$55 per user. Generated \$56K+ revenue in first year of operations
- Designed Degen Mode — one-click leveraged strategy execution that abstracted complex financial operations (borrowing, swapping, liquidity provisioning) into automated strategies while constraining capital to approved deployment channels for solvency
- Designed the Dynamic Interest Algorithm (DIAL, v1) for term-deposit lending (utilization + commitment tranches). Evolved to an Interest Rate Model (v2) — kinked utilization curve — for auditability and determinism
- Led product across engineering, community, and BD with a 16-person team. Deprioritized exchange listing to focus on platform security — culminating in a CertiK security audit
- Orchestrated 7 financial infrastructure integrations for pricing, liquidity, and risk data. Secured 180,000 STRK and \$50K (Harmony) in ecosystem grants across 4 rounds. Authored [EIP-5299](#)
- Published 2 technical whitepapers on protocol architecture
- Led structured wind-down — infrastructure adoption stalled and migration cost exceeded expected ROI. Deployed on a second chain (Base) to validate platform portability

Finin

Oct 2019 – Jul 2020

Head of Product — [acquired by Open Financial Technologies](#)

Bengaluru

- Digital-first neobank — savings accounts, cards, and personal finance tools for young Indians
- Employee #2. Built engineering team from 0 to 16
- Shipped core banking product end-to-end — KYC onboarding, savings accounts, card issuance, transaction history
- Integrated State Bank of Mauritius as core banking partner; managed banking API integration and compliance
- Built unified transactional intelligence using account aggregators, surfaced through an in-app conversational chatbot
- Acquired 5,000 savings accounts through product-led growth. Navigated RBI regulatory requirements for digital banking
- Company acquired by Open Financial Technologies — validated product-market fit

Parashar

2024 – Present

Product & AI (Side Project)

- AI consumer product applying predictive analysis to a traditional knowledge domain
- Defined product vision, scoped problem space, and designed end-to-end UX; translated domain rules into AI training requirements and evaluation criteria

Guardrail

2016 – Present

Managing Partner — [guardrail.fund](#)

- Conviction-driven single-family office deploying principal capital across digital assets, precious metals, real estate, and frontier tech. 10+ year horizon
- Sourced and evaluated deal flow; developed market theses for early-stage digital assets (2017–2019). Angel investor in Gushwork (\$9M seed)

Earlier Experience

Echo · Qulp · AIESEC

- **Echo** (Co-founder, 2016–2017) — Location-based social discovery. Facebook FBSTART. SURGE 2016. 3,000 users. #13 India Play Store, zero marketing spend
- **Qulp** (Founder, 2013–2015) — Hardware innovation platform. Google Launchpad 2014. TiE Asia regional finalists 2014. \$60K in pre-orders. Team of 7
- **AIESEC IIT Kharagpur** (VP Marketing & PR, 2010–2013) — Led 13-person team across promotions, branding, and media. 1st place, Nokia-AIESEC India campaign

PUBLISHED WORK & SPEAKING

[EIP-5299: Proposed Layer3 scaling EIP — discussion](#)

[Published whitepaper on lending protocol architecture](#)

[DIAL: Dynamic Interest Algorithm \(v1\) — Interest Rate Model \(v2\)](#)

[Speaker, Token 2049 \(2022\)](#)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Python · SQL · TypeScript · JavaScript · Amplitude · Mixpanel · Figma · Jira/Linear · Notion · API Design · Data Modeling · GitHub

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Strategy · 0→1 Product Building · Fintech · Lending · Risk Framework Design · AI Product Design · Platform Architecture · Team Leadership · Data-Driven Growth · User Acquisition · Go-to-Market

EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur